



Royal University of Phnom Penh

Institute of Foreign Languages

Department of English

Bachelor of Education (TEFL) and Bachelor of Arts in English

Subject: RW402

Lecturer: Sam Chanphirun

Class: E4.7

Major Assignment

Topic: Youth and Their Future Career

Submitted by Team2:

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Acknowledgements

First and foremost, we would like to express our deepest gratitude to our academic advisor, Mr. Sam Chanpirum, whose valuable guidance, encouragement, and insightful feedback played a critical role throughout the entire process of this project. His support has helped us stay focused, grow professionally, and deliver meaningful outcomes.

We also extend our sincere appreciation to YRDP (Youth Resource Development Program) for their generous support and collaboration, especially in helping us reach targeted youth participants and enabling the smooth implementation of this initiative.

Our heartfelt thanks go to the guest speakers who volunteered their time and expertise to share real-world experiences from both social science and science fields. Their presence was inspiring and greatly enriched the students' understanding of career possibilities.

We are also thankful to the participating students whose enthusiasm and active participation made the event impactful. Their feedback and reflections are at the heart of our findings and future direction.

Last but not least, we would like to thank all project members who worked collaboratively and dedicated their time and effort—from planning and organizing to implementation and reporting. This project would not have been possible without everyone's contribution.

Thank you all for being a part of this journey toward building better career awareness for Cambodian youth.

Executive Summary

This project aimed to raise awareness and provide practical knowledge to Cambodian youth about career selection in both social science and science fields. Recognizing that many students face confusion when choosing a major or career path—often due to limited guidance and exposure—the project team organized a participatory panel discussion featuring two professional guest speakers: one from the social science field and another from the science/technical field. The event was designed to reduce the mismatch between academic choices and labor market needs, and to promote youth self-development.

The panel discussion was attended by selected high school and university students, with the support of the Youth Resource Development Program (YRDP), which helped identify and invite suitable participants. The project used a qualitative methodology, including pre-tests and post-tests, participant observation, and feedback collection, to assess changes in knowledge, interest, and confidence. Tools such as Google Forms, Canva, and Excel were used throughout the project to design, collect, and analyze data.

Key findings indicated that students significantly improved their understanding of career options after the discussion. More than 75% showed better results in their post-tests, and 85% reported that the session helped them gain new insight into career paths in both fields. Many expressed that it was their first time hearing directly from professionals and felt more confident to explore their future options.

Despite some limitations—such as the short time frame and limited career fields represented—the project was successful in meeting its objectives. The event helped bridge the gap between education and employment by combining expert experience, student engagement, and reflection.

The team recommends expanding this model by including more diverse career speakers and offering follow-up activities such as mentorship or skills workshops. This project demonstrated that a well-facilitated panel discussion can be an impactful method for youth career orientation and personal development.

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1. Research Background

Many Cambodian students struggle to choose the right major due to a lack of career guidance and market awareness. Sorn and Suon (2022) found that only 10% of students enroll in science or health fields, while 70% choose business and social sciences. Eam et al. (2019) surveyed 2,016 freshmen and found that only 25.6% pursued STEM, often due to a lack of proper guidance. Pov et al. (2024) reported that 54% of students who studied science in high school switched to non-STEM majors in university, influenced by parental advice and easier exams.

As a result, it highlights the need for better academic counseling and career awareness to help students make informed choices.

2. Research Problem Statement

The availability of AI-powered chatbots offers significant potential for enhancing educational and career guidance. However, these systems often struggle with accurately interpreting complex, unstructured data formats, such as PDF documents containing intricate tables and diverse layouts. This limitation can lead to the generation of hallucinated or inaccurate responses, undermining the reliability of the guidance provided (Wong, 2022).

In the context of Cambodia, students frequently encounter obstacles in accessing personalized academic and career guidance. Research indicates that while AI chatbots can support self-paced learning, there is a pressing need for more tailored guidance solutions to address individual student needs (Eav, 2024). The integration of AI in education is transforming learning experiences in the country, yet challenges persist in providing equitable access to personalized guidance tools, especially in rural areas (Sol et al., 2024).

Therefore, there is a critical need to develop AI-driven chatbot systems capable of accurately processing complex, unstructured educational data and delivering personalized, context-aware guidance. Such systems would significantly enhance

the decision-making capabilities of Cambodian students regarding their academic and career paths.

3. Research Goal and Objectives

Goal:

To support Grade 11 students in making informed and appropriate decisions when selecting their academic specialization by enhancing their understanding of each stream's relevance, career implications, and alignment with personal strengths and labor market demands.

Objectives:

- To raise awareness among Grade 11 students about the key differences between the social sciences and natural sciences, including their academic content, future study paths, and career options.
- To provide expert guidance through teachers, career counselors, and professionals to help students explore their interests and match them with suitable specializations.
- To develop students' critical thinking in analyzing their personal strengths, academic performance, and long-term goals to make informed specialization choices.
- To introduce labor market trends and future career demands to help students understand how different specializations align with real-world opportunities.
- To prevent misinformed decisions that can lead to academic disengagement, frequent changes in study direction, or dropping out, by offering accurate and accessible information early in the decision-making process.
- To encourage the creation of individual career plans by equipping students with knowledge, tools, and resources for future planning, ensuring they have a clear and confident academic path forward.

4. Project Timeline

No	Activities	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Week 6	Week 7	Week 8	Week 9	Week 10
1	Project Preparation & Team Formation										
2	Content Development & Guest Speaker Coordination										
3	Event Execution										
4	Data Analysis										
5	Report										

 Plan
  Actual

From Week 1 to Week 3, the team will be formed with clear roles (MC, moderator, note-taker, logistics), and internal meetings will be held to define project goals and responsibilities, draft the concept note, and plan the venue, date, and panel format in alignment with YRDP expectations. In Weeks 3 to 4, two guest speakers (from social science and science fields) will be confirmed, guiding questions developed, and pre/post-test forms and promotional materials designed, along with coordination of logistics and speaker bios. Weeks 5 to 7 focus on event execution, including venue setup, pre-test distribution, speaker introductions, the panel discussion, Q&A session, post-test, feedback collection, and documentation. In Weeks 7 to 8, pre/post-test data will be analyzed, and feedback reviewed. Finally, in Weeks 9 to 10, the final report and slide presentation will be prepared for IFL, along with a summary for social media or stakeholder sharing, and the report will be submitted to YRDP and school partners.

Chapter 2: Methodology

1. Project Design Approach

This project used a participatory, workshop-based approach centered around a panel discussion. It was designed to be interactive and student-focused, allowing youth to hear from professionals, ask questions, and reflect on their own aspirations.

2. Participants

The target participants included:

- High school students who had not yet chosen between social science and science streams.
- University students who were still unclear about their future career paths or lacked awareness of labor market trends.

These participants were selected in collaboration with the funder, YRDP (Youth Resource Development Program), which helped identify youth who would benefit most from this panel discussion. The participants were chosen based on their openness to career exploration and their need for practical guidance.

To support the student audience, two guest speakers were invited:

- Speaker 1: Background in Social Science (e.g., community work, development studies) - aimed at students interested in human and societal issues.
- Speaker 2: Background in Real Science (e.g., engineering, IT) - aimed at students curious about STEM and technical careers.

3. Data Collection Methods

We used qualitative methods, including:

- Pre-test and post-test questionnaires to assess knowledge improvement
- Observation during the event to gauge engagement and participation
- Google Form feedback to collect reflections and suggestions

4. Tools and Techniques Used

- Google Forms: for pre/post-test and feedback collection
- Canva: to design promotional posters and slides
- Field notes and photos: for documentation and reflection

Chapter 3: Project Activities

1. Project Setup

The project began with internal planning, delegation of tasks, and communication with potential speakers. The team also created digital materials for promotion and invited participants through YRDP's network.

2. Team Structure

Role	Member Name	Responsibility
Team Leader	Nang Sreynich	• Coordinate all departments and ensure smooth communication among team members. • Collaborate with the school director and stakeholders to secure support and approvals. • Monitor progress and resolve any issues during project implementation. • Prepare final reports to evaluate the impact of the workshops.
Finance Officer	Prak Nousocheata	• Create and manage the project budget for all workshops. • Allocate resources for logistics, curriculum development, and other needs. • Prepare financial reports and ensure accountability. • Identify funding gaps and explore potential sponsorships or donors.
Curriculum Developer	Rith Chanthya	• Create lesson plans to introduce Social Science and Real Science majors effectively.

		• Develop personalized assessment tools to help students identify their strengths and interests. • Incorporate gender equity and digital literacy themes into the curriculum
Academic Counselor	Davy Loung	• Offer the group counseling sessions to help students explore Social Science and Real Science tracks. • Use assessment tools to identify students' strengths and align them with potential careers. • Address concerns and stereotypes, particularly focusing on gender equity in academic and career decisions. • Provide students with a roadmap for pursuing their chosen academic paths.
Career Mentors	San Poovan	Prepare to invite the guest speakers to share personal experiences and career journeys in Social Science and Real Science fields. Address student queries about specific career options and academic paths. Offer practical advice on navigating challenges and achieving career goals. Motivate students by challenging stereotypes and promoting equal opportunities for all.

3. Project Execution

The panel discussion took place in person, featuring two guest speakers—one from a social science background and the other from a real science/technical background. Students engaged in pre-tests, listened to the discussion, asked questions, and completed post-tests and feedback forms.

4. Agenda of Event

- Opening by MC
- Introduction of guest speakers
- Panel discussion (moderated Q&A format)
- Interactive Q&A with audience
- Post-test and feedback collection
- Closing and group photo

5. Budget Execution

ផែនការចំណាយលម្អិតនៃគម្រោង/Detail Budget Plan						
ល.រ No	ពិពណ៌នា/Description	ប្រភេទ/Unit	បរិមាណ Quantity	ចំនួនដង Time	តម្លៃឯកតា Unit Price	តម្លៃសរុប Total Amount
1	Communication (phone card)	Phone card	1	1	10	10
2	Materials for organizing activity	Lumpsum	1	1	10	10
3	Copy and printing documents	Lumpsum	1	1	12	12
4	Refreshments for participants	Person	66	1	3	198
5	Lunch for organizers committee	Person	6	1	5	30
6	Gratification for guest speakers	Person	2	1	15	30
7	Contribution Electricity Consumption	Lumpsum	1	1	20	20
Total						310

Chapter 4: Result & Findings

1. Participant Demographics

There are 42 students responding to the workshop evaluation. 61.9% are women and 38.1 are men. The age of respondents is between 16 - 18 years old which is 19% are in the group age of 16 years old, 64.3% are in the group age of 17 years old, and 16.7% are in the group age of 18 years old. All of the respondents are from grade 11.

2. Before the Panel Discussion Interpretation

Through our quick assessment with the some students who attended the workshop, their understanding of further preparation, field of study, and future jobs are low. This could be interpreted that they have not set a goal for their future career.

3. Career Awareness and Decision Making

Making informed decisions and understanding pathways in careers is an important milestone to reach for any student. The project undertaken by our teams at the Royal University of Phnom Penh showcased the struggles and challenges that Cambodian youth deal with, including lack of exposure to career pathways as well as guidance when selecting majors. The project proved how powerful firsthand insights are in addressing the education-employment gap by bringing professionals from various fields like social science and science through a panel discussion. One of the most important insights collected was that 85% of participants reported having different perspectives on potential career pathways as a result of participating in the project which many admitted also boosted their self-esteem in decision-making abilities.

Nonetheless, the study was able to uncover gaps such as inadequate school counseling services and a need for ongoing workshops specifically focused on careers. Priorities should also include program follow-up and mentorship

after the dynamic no longer requires supervision. This highlights the need for proactive structured activities aimed at creating awareness about different careers in order to effectively help students integrate their skills, areas of interest, and market demands.

3.1. Importance of Career- Aligned Education

Career education must equip students with the knowledge and skills appropriate for the skills required in the changing labor market. Through academic courses based on the demands of the labor market, students are equipped to make suitable course selections, reducing cases of qualification mismatch and unemployment. It promotes a better understanding of how certain topics turn into real careers, allowing students to pursue paths that are appropriate for their talents, interests, and social needs. For instance, introducing students to scientists and social scientists—demonstrated in the RW402 project—heightens their understanding of the different possibilities and demands of specific professions, e.g., the necessity of STEM education for medical professions.

In addition, exploring a career through education bridges the gap between practice and theory, making students efficient contributors to the economy with an inner sense of satisfaction. For such prospects to be more effective, schools must have a strong counseling program, mentorship, and connections with industries in order to provide students with constant advice and encouragement in performing their careers in the future.

3.2. Role of trending job market

The job market plays an important role in shaping people's education and career decisions. With the following trend in advanced technology, the students also need to be considered about both education and future career.

The research found out that most students who study in high school are really about their future goal and their future career, but they are not clear about making decisions for their future path. As part of our project evaluation, Before our workshop, Students did not understand much about the job market and how they choose their university to align with their

future career. A few of them thought that the trending job market is all about choosing the career that is trending, and some they thought it is about the job that isn't related to mathematics.

After the career orientation, almost 100% of participants understand that understanding labor marketing demand and trending jobs is critical. It helps them to grow their education and their career opportunity at the same time. The result strongly highlights the growing awareness among the students of aligning their current education and skill with current and future market needs. They understand that they need to know about the gap between education and employment that reflect real-world trends.

4. Influence Factors in Career Decision

The assessment revealed five primary factors influencing Grade 11 students' career decisions:

First, parental influence emerged as the dominant factor. The research found that 54% of students who studied science switched to non-STEM majors due to parental advice favoring business-oriented careers perceived as more stable. Family expectations heavily shaped students' academic choices over personal interests.

Second, information gaps significantly impacted decision-making. Before the workshop, students demonstrated limited understanding of how Grade 11 specialization connects to future careers. Many were unaware that professions like medicine require science stream prerequisites.

Third, peer influence and social perceptions affected choices. Social sciences were perceived as "easier" options, while science streams were viewed as challenging but rewarding. Gender stereotypes also influenced field selection.

Fourth, academic performance shaped student confidence. Those struggling with mathematics or science avoided STEM fields regardless of actual

interest, highlighting the need for academic support and confidence building.

Finally, limited career counseling services left students without adequate guidance. Participants reported minimal access to professional counselors or structured career exploration programs during this critical decision period.

5. Best Career Decision Approach

Based on project findings, five key approaches emerged for effective career decision-making:

Multi-stakeholder collaboration proved most effective. The panel discussion showed that direct professional input significantly enhanced student understanding, with 85% of participants reporting changed perspectives on career pathways. Including parents in guidance sessions ensures family support aligns with student interests.

Early and continuous career exploration benefits students throughout the decision process. The workshop demonstrated that single interventions create substantial impact, indicating that systematic exposure to various career paths through workshops and mentorship programs yields positive results.

Personalized assessment and counseling address individual student needs. Using assessment tools to identify strengths, interests, and values provides tailored guidance rather than generic approaches, helping students make decisions based on their unique circumstances and abilities.

Integration of labor market information ensures realistic career planning. Students require current data on job availability, salary expectations, and growth prospects to make informed decisions that align with market realities and personal goals.

Structured follow-up support prevents academic disengagement. Ongoing mentorship and regular plan reviews help students adjust their paths as they

gain experience, reducing the likelihood of frequent changes in study direction or dropout rates identified in the research background.

6. Summary

Before the workshop, most students had little understanding or concern about choosing their academic major. After attending, they realized the importance of selecting between science and social science, as it directly connects to their future careers. Many were surprised to learn, for example, that becoming a doctor requires choosing the science stream due to subjects like biology and chemistry.

The workshop also revealed that students lack clear information and guidance, especially in grade 11. There is a need for strong school counseling services to help students plan their futures. After the panel discussion, students became more engaged, asked thoughtful questions, and felt more confident about their academic and career choices.

Chapter 5: Conclusion

1. Limitations

The project faced limitations including limited time for deeper engagement or follow-up sessions, representation of only two career paths (science and social science), and a relatively small sample size, which restricts broader generalization of the findings.

2. Lesson Learnt

We found that interactive panel discussions are a powerful way to engage and guide students in exploring different career paths. By collaborating with NGOs like YRDP, we were able to effectively reach our target participants. We also learned that using visual tools such as slides and real-life stories made the session more relatable and impactful for the students.

3. Recommendations and Future Works

- Expand the panel to include more diverse career fields
- Offer mentorship or follow-up activities to reinforce learning
- Partner with more schools or community centers for greater reach

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Appendices

1. Brochure

“Your future begins with what you learn—and grows with how you connect. Discover your strengths, explore your passions, and find your path.”

Smart Major Choices, Stronger Futures

កម្មវិធីតម្រង់ទិស

តើការព្យាបាលសង្គម វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ និងវិទ្យាសាស្ត្រពិត ទាក់ទងនឹងការងារក្នុងសង្គម ដោយរបៀបណា?

វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រពិត
Real Science

វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រពិតគឺជាការសិក្សាអំពីអង្គធាតុដែលមានលក្ខណៈជាក់លាក់ និងអាចវាស់ស្ទង់បាន។ វាផ្តល់នូវការយល់ដឹងអំពីច្បាប់ធម្មជាតិ និងការអនុវត្តវា។

វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រសង្គម
Social Science

វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រសង្គមផ្តោតលើការសិក្សាអំពីអង្គធាតុដែលមានលក្ខណៈសង្គម និងការអនុវត្តវា។

ជំនាញផ្សេងទៀតដែលសំខាន់ៗ

ជំនាញសំខាន់ៗដែលទាំងស្រុង វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រសង្គម និងវិទ្យាសាស្ត្រពិត ត្រូវតែមាន៖

- Computer Skills (កុំព្យូទ័រ)
- International Language (ភាសាអន្តរជាតិ)
- Soft-skills (ជំនាញស្រួច)

វិស័យវិទ្យាសាស្ត្រពិត ទៅកម្ពុជា

1. វិស័យ ឧស្សាហកម្ម (Engineering & Technology)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
2. វិស័យ វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (Biology & Health Sciences)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
3. វិស័យ គីមី (Physics & Chemistry)
 - គីមី (គីមី)
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4. វិស័យ គណិតវិទ្យា (Mathematics)
 - គណិតវិទ្យា (គណិតវិទ្យា)
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វិស័យវិទ្យាសាស្ត្រសង្គម ទៅកម្ពុជា

1. វិស័យ ឧស្សាហកម្ម (Engineering & Technology)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
 - ឧស្សាហកម្ម (ឧស្សាហកម្ម)
2. វិស័យ វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (Biology & Health Sciences)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
 - វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ (វិទ្យាសាស្ត្រ)
3. វិស័យ គីមី (Physics & Chemistry)
 - គីមី (គីមី)
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4. វិស័យ គណិតវិទ្យា (Mathematics)
 - គណិតវិទ្យា (គណិតវិទ្យា)
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 - គណិតវិទ្យា (គណិតវិទ្យា)

2. Agenda

KID & THEIR FUTUR CAREER

Guiding students to make informed choices between Social and Real Sciences — empowering their future with real-world insights and inspiration.

14 JUNE, 2025

8:00 AM - 11:00AM

INDRADEVI HIGH SCHOOL
HVHR+3H5, Street 592, Phnom Penh

8:00 AM - 8:30 AM

- Registration
- Welcome
- Preparation

8:30 AM - 8:45 AM

- Introduce our Team
- Objective of Workshop
- Pre-Test

8:45 AM - 9:05 PM

- Guest Speaker Introduction
- Why Social Science?
- Job with Social Science

9:05 AM - 9:25 AM

- Guest Speaker Introduction
- Why Real Science?
- Job with Real Science

9:25 AM - 9:40 AM

- Game
- Reflection
- Q & A

9:40 AM - 10:00 AM

- Key Motivation to students
- Post-Test
- Group photos

10:00 AM - 11:00 AM

- Discussion Panel for Finding Your Path - Skills and Majors Talk

Your future begins with what you learn—and grows with how you connect. Discover your strengths, explore your passions, and find your path.

3. Group Photos

